

[Return to Search](#)

Original Page: 96**Culture (OWC):** [Ovimbundu \(FP13\)](#)**Region:** Africa**Sub Region:** Southern Africa**Field Date:** 1955-1956**Coverage Date:** 1955-1956**Place Coverage:** Epalanga, Huambo, Angola**Section Title(S):** 2. Kinship Terms • 3. Kinship Norms

There exist marked variations in terminology in Umbundu country.¹⁶ For instance, *sekulu* seems to be used for mother's brother only in north-western Umbundu country. Elsewhere *manu*¹⁷ is used for mother's brother, and *sekulu* is used for grandfather. At Caconda, where there has been strong Portuguese influence since the eighteenth century, only the Portuguese kinship terms are known.¹⁸

[177](#)
[Acculturation And Culture Contact](#)

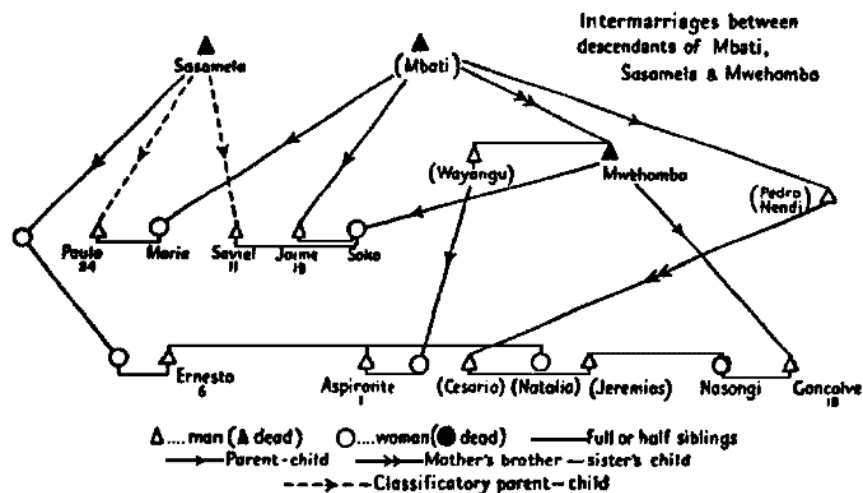
[184](#)
[Cultural Participation](#)

[601](#)
[Kinship Terminology](#)

CHART 2. Mbatí, Mwehombo and some of their kin. For Mbatí (dead, non-member) and Mwehombo (dead, former member) see Chapter III, section 1. For Sasamela (dead, former member) and Cesario, Jeremias, Natalia, Pedro Nendi, and Wayangu (all living non-members) see List II (pp. 55–6). The rest of the individuals named on the chart are members of Epalanga. Paulo and Saviel were 'brothers', both patrilocally and matrilocally.

[601](#)
[Kinship Terminology](#)

[621](#)
[Community Structure](#)

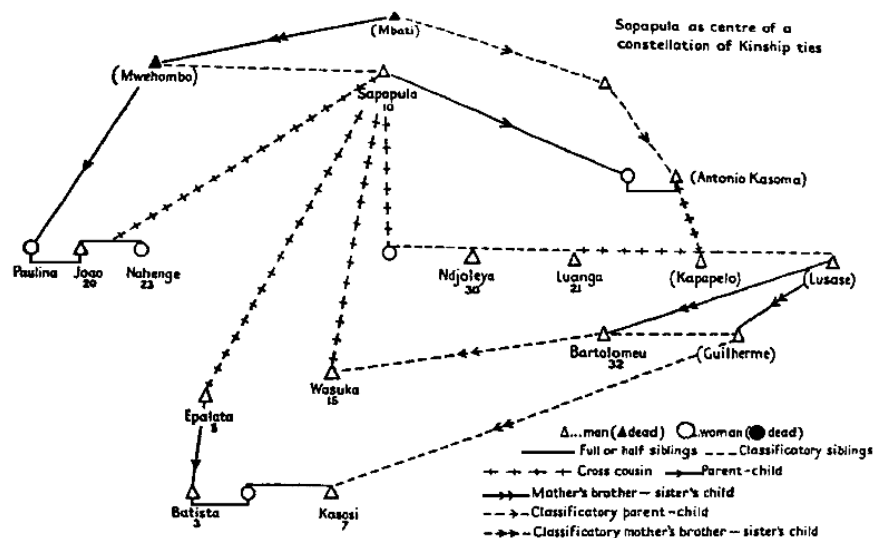


3. Kinship Norms

In this section I shall describe the relations that existed within the elementary family in the time of the rubber trade. A man 97

CHART 3. Sapapula as the centre of a constellation of kinship ties. It is interesting to note how, in view of the conflict described in Chapter IX, Sapapula is linked to Guilherme, Kapapelo, and Lusase by several paths. All are living members of Epalanga except for Mbatu and Mwehombo (for whom see note to Chart 2) and Antonio Kasoma, Guilherme, Kapapelo, and Lusase. For details on these living non-members see List II, pp. 55-6. Not all ties existing between these individuals have been shown.

Correction. The relation of Bartolomeu and Guilherme to Lusase and of Mwehombo to Mbatu should be that of classificatory sister's sons.



98 did not eat or chat with his eldest son or his daughters. Nor did a woman eat or chat with her sons. By 'chatting' I mean a prolonged conversation. It was not forbidden for people in these relationships to speak to one another. Nor could a man eat or joke with his sister (although chatting was permitted) or be alone with her at night. A grown man could not sleep in the same room as his father, except perhaps on a journey, nor could he wear his father's

593

Family Relationships

601

Kinship Terminology

621

Community Structure

clothes while he was still alive. A grown woman might sleep in the same room as her mother, provided they were far apart.

¹⁶ For other lists of kinship terms see Hastings, pp. 83–85. Childs, pp. 47–56. M. Howse, *Umbundu Lessons* (Dondi, 1955), Vol. II, pp. 195–7.

¹⁷ Etymologically, *manu* seems to mean ‘mother-person’.

¹⁸ Private information.

Human Relations Area Files

755 Prospect Street

New Haven, CT 06511

General Inquiries: ✉ hraf@yale.edu

Issues and Bugs: ✉ hraf-support@yale.edu



[Terms and Conditions](#) · [Accessibility](#) · [Cookie Policy](#)